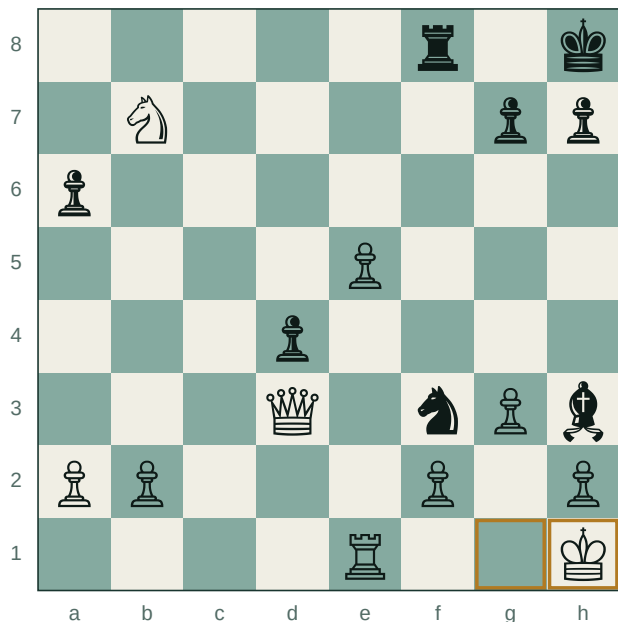


Attraction tactics: Black, move 31

Attraction tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 31.Kh1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

31...Bg2+ 32. Kxg2 Nxe1+ 33. Kf1 Nxd3

31...Bg2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **32.Kxg2**.

32...Nxe1+ Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. From e1 it attacks king on g2 and queen on d3. Recorded reply: **33.Kf1**.

33...Nxd3 The knight captures the queen on d3.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 12 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +11. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +11:** the balance goes from -8 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The opponent may decline the offered material. Compare refusal with the recorded continuation before calling the sacrifice forced.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Attraction draws a piece onto a square where a later tactic becomes possible. Sacrifices often work by changing the king's or queen's location rather than winning immediately.

HOW TO LOOK

Ask which enemy piece must be moved to a specific square for your next check, fork, or mating pattern to work.

The defending king is on h1. Geometrically undefended: knight on b7 and queen on d3. Check for tactical protection.